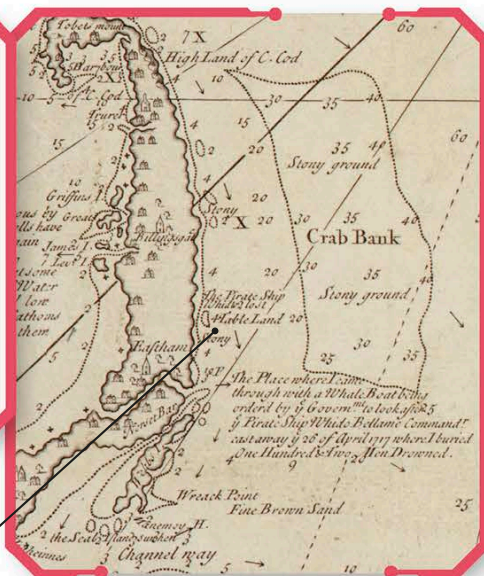


Marking the spot

In 1717, as news of the *Whydah's* sinking spread, the governor of Massachusetts sent Captain Cyprian Southack to collect any valuables he could find. Southack couldn't salvage anything, but he did mark the wreck location on a map.

Notes on the map say where the ship was lost, and that 102 men drowned.



Archaeologist at work

The *Whydah* wreck site is still being explored by teams of divers. All finds are taken to a laboratory, where they are painstakingly excavated by expert archaeologists.

Archaeologists work slowly and delicately, to avoid damaging the artifacts.



Copper bracelets such as these, found at the wreck site, were used to pay for enslaved people in Africa.

Piracy and the slave trade

Pirates often came across ships involved in the transatlantic slave trade, in which enslaved Africans were taken to, and sold in, the Americas. Many pirates were Black—some joined pirate crews after escaping slavery, and others when the slave ships they were held on were seized.

Hidden treasure

Objects buried in the sandy seafloor end up encased in hard clumps called concretions. These form when iron reacts with salts in the water. They are soaked in freshwater tanks to preserve the items inside until these can be excavated, by hand or chemically.



A coin that has been hidden from view for over 300 years is revealed.



This ring and Spanish coins were found at the *Whydah* wreck site.

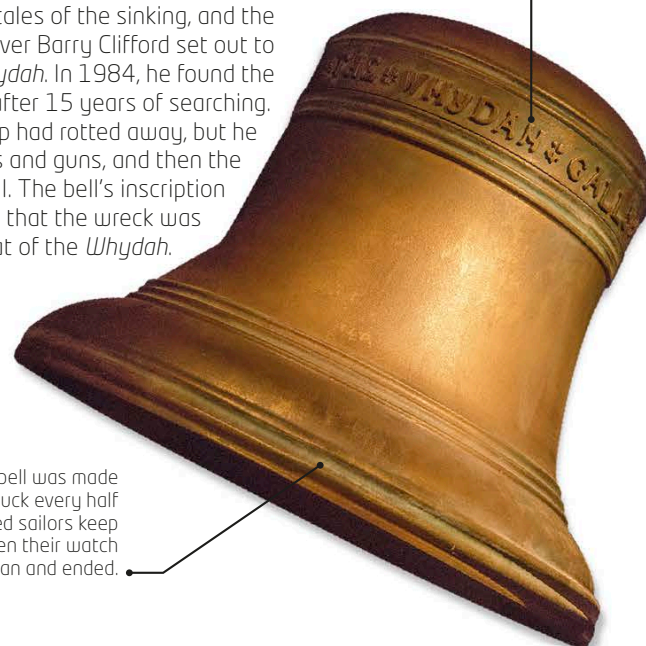
Pirate gold

Spanish galleons constantly crossed the Atlantic Ocean, carrying gold and silver from the Americas to Europe. Spanish coins were used as currency all over the world and often ended up in pirate treasure troves.

Treasure hunt

Stirred by tales of the sinking, and the 1717 map, diver Barry Clifford set out to find the *Whydah*. In 1984, he found the wreck site after 15 years of searching.

The ship had rotted away, but he found coins and guns, and then the ship's bell. The bell's inscription confirmed that the wreck was definitely that of the *Whydah*.



The *Whydah's* bell.
has writing around
the top that says
"Whydah Gally 1716".

The ship's bell was made of bronze. Struck every half hour, it helped sailors keep track of when their watch began and ended.